

CEO

Victor Crane, Bear Raider

CEO · EXECUTIVE



HIRE

◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Financials funding source.

Whenever a Reputation, Corporate, or Regulation Stress Test resolves, gain 2 Surplus.

Commit this employee to look at the top card of an opponent's deck.

Has read your footnotes more closely than your auditors, and has already called the press.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 213 / 357

Office Location



EXCLUSIVE

▲ Cyber

Exclusive: Headquarters only; no other offices.

At the start of your turn, if you control an employee other than your CEO, gain 1 Surplus (once, regardless of copies).

The first employee you hire on your turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

The headquarters is wherever the charger is.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 342 / 357

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

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ALPHA EX MACHINA

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Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



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FINANCIALS



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FINANCIALS



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FINANCIALS



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ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Private Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½

each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Private Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½

each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Private Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½

each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1

each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1

each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 357

INVESTMENT

Equity - Value

INVESTMENT

COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1

each turn

SALE

1

any time

▲ Long-Term Equity ▼ Inflation

Safe, stable, and boring.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 047 / 357

INVESTMENT

Litigation Finance

ILLIQUID

COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1

each turn

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation ▼ Litigation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Whenever a Litigation Stress Test resolves, gain 1 Surplus.

When claims severity rises, someone funds the lawsuit.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 064 / 357

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

Sports-Gambling Prediction Markets

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

COST	YIELD	SALE
◆ 2	● 1 each turn	1 any time

SIGNATURE

▲ **Regulation**

Signature: one copy per deck.

Whenever a Regulation, Market, or Geopolitical Stress Test resolves, gain 1 Surplus.

Even the local pub needs to hedge sometimes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 074 / 357

INVESTMENT

INVESTMENT

Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT

COST	YIELD	SALE
◆ 2	● 1 each turn	1 any time

▲ **Inflation** ▼ **Short-Term Equity**

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 051 / 357

PROGRAM

PROGRAM

Short Sale

RESPONSE

COST
◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Play only against a Market Stress Test. Gain 3 Surplus.

Schadenfreude: German for enjoying someone else's portfolio falling.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 122 / 357

PROGRAM

PROGRAM

Put Option

RESPONSE

COST
◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Prevent all loss to you from this Stress Test's Short-Term Equity, Long-Term Equity, and Volatility clauses.

Nobody puts equity in the corner.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 121 / 357

PROGRAM

PROGRAM

Put Option

RESPONSE

COST
◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Prevent all loss to you from this Stress Test's Short-Term Equity, Long-Term Equity, and Volatility clauses.

Nobody puts equity in the corner.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 121 / 357

PROGRAM

PROGRAM

Fire Sale

RESPONSE

COST
◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: answers a sale, not a Stress Test.

Play right after a company with less than 10 Surplus sells an investment.

Every company with less than 15 Surplus, including you, sells every copy of that investment it controls for half its Sale value in Surplus, rounded down.

The first one out the door gets a price, while everyone behind gets an offer.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 143 / 357

TOOL

TOOL

Valuation Spreadsheet

SOFTWARE

PRICE
◆ 2

At the start of your turn, if you control an investment, gain 1 more Surplus.

Whenever a Stress Test with a Short-Term Equity or Long-Term Equity clause hits you, lose 2 more Surplus.

Tab 7 divides by the sum instead of the average, but nobody has opened Tab 7 since 2011.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 349 / 357

TALENT

TALENT

Research Analyst

FRONT LINE

HIRE
◆ 4

Requires a Financials funding source.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Publishes forty pages a day, of which occasionally one is right.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 218 / 357

SIGNATURE TOOL

SIGNATURE TOOL

Generative AI Pilot

SOFTWARE

PRICE	CARRYING COST
◆ 2	● 1 each turn

SIGNATURE AI

▲ **Cyber**

Signature: one copy per deck; AI: AI Bubble Bursts destroys it.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Summarizes every report in the building, including three that don't exist.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 352 / 357

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Short-Seller Report

REPUTATION

COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 2 Surplus per investment they control and 1 per Dark card on their board, plus 4 more.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Blockchain Co. it controls.

Ninety-four pages, a catchy name, and a very bad morning for investor relations.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 271 / 357

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Short and Distort

REPUTATION

DARK

COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Target opponent loses 2 Surplus per investment they control, plus 6 more.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Blockchain Co. it controls.

Step one: short the stock. Step two: post the rumor. There is no step three.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 289 / 357

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Smear Campaign

REPUTATION

DARK

COST

◆ 3

HITS

Each opponent

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Each opponent loses 3 Surplus. Then they can't add a funding source on their next turn.

Sources close to no one say your rivals are in trouble.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 290 / 357

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Executive Scandal

REPUTATION

COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 1 Surplus per Dark card on their board and 1 per Dark card in their discard pile, plus 6 more. Then they have one employee or CEO to fire, chosen by the runner.

Leaked texts, a 6 a.m. board call, and a very generous severance.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 273 / 357

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Congressional Hearing

REGULATION

COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile and 1 per Dark card on their board.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Feeder Fund it controls.

I don't recall, Senator. I'd have to check with my team. My team has been let go.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 292 / 357

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Whistleblower

CORPORATE

COST

◆ 2

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Shell Company, Feeder Fund, Affiliate Loan, or Guaranteed Returns Fund it controls.

She kept copies of everything, including the email telling her not to.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 291 / 357

INVESTMENT

Trading Desk

INVESTMENT

COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

▲ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if a Market Stress Test hits you.

Buys low, sells high, and has a very good explanation for the other days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 080 / 357

INVESTMENT

Trading Desk

INVESTMENT

COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

▲ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if a Market Stress Test hits you.

Buys low, sells high, and has a very good explanation for the other days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 080 / 357

SIGNATURE PROGRAM

Everything Is Securities Fraud

RESPONSE

COST

◆ 3

SIGNATURE

RESPONSE

Signature: one copy per deck; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

When this Stress Test ends, target opponent loses as much Surplus again as Stress Tests have cost them this round.

The hurricane was nobody's fault, but the stock drop, says the complaint, was the CFO's.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 148 / 357

Viral Solvency Rumor

REPUTATION



COST

◆ 6

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 2 Surplus per funding source they control. Then they discard half their Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

The stock fell 40 percent on no news, which turned out to be the news.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 305 / 357

Evergreen Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0

run start

▲ Credit

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

Liquid in the brochure, quarterly in the prospectus, gated in the headline.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 040 / 357

Evergreen Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0

run start

▲ Credit

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

Liquid in the brochure, quarterly in the prospectus, gated in the headline.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 040 / 357

Evergreen Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0

run start

▲ Credit

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

Liquid in the brochure, quarterly in the prospectus, gated in the headline.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 040 / 357

Noncompete Injunction

LITIGATION



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one employee or CEO to fire, chosen by the runner.

The judge agreed that the agreement was enforceable, and that the new job started in eighteen months.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 330 / 357

Asset Freeze

GEOPOLITICAL



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one Investment to discard without Sale proceeds, chosen by the runner.

The position was marked at full value right up until the moment it could not be sold, moved, or mentioned.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 329 / 357

AI Bubble Bursts

MARKET



HITS

Every company from the pile

SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every AI card and every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

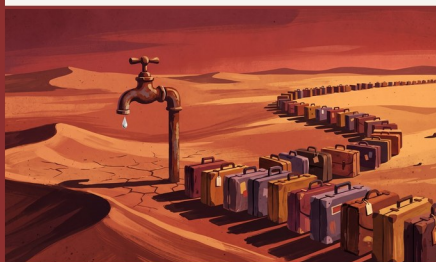
It was three laptops in a trench coat the whole time.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 257 / 357

Liquidity Crunch

LIQUIDITY



HITS

Every company from the pile

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Credit ▲ Volatility

Every company loses 3 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 3 per Short-Term Equity exposure, 3 per Credit exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Private Credit Fund it controls.

Everyone wants cash, so nobody is bidding on your assets.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 262 / 357

Flash Crash

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company from the pile

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

On May 6, 2010, a burst of automated selling briefly wiped about a trillion dollars off the value of U.S. stocks. The Dow fell almost 1,000 points in minutes, then mostly came back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 276 / 357

Off-Channel Communications Sweep

REGULATION - AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 3 Surplus per employee it controls other than its CEO, 1 per Dark card on its board, and 1 per Dark card in its discard pile.

In 2022 US regulators fined sixteen banks and brokers more than \$1.8 billion for business discussed on personal phones. No wrongdoing was found in the messages; the messages were the wrongdoing.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 300 / 357

Volmaggodon

MARKET - AS-IF REPLAY, 2018



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Inverse VIX Note it controls.

On February 5, 2018, a volatility spike caused inverse-volatility notes to collapse.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 306 / 357

Bird Flu Pandemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

▲ Mortality

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

Public health agencies have tracked the strain for years.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 234 / 357

Quantitative Easing

RATES



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

ACT OF GOD

▲ Low Interest Rates

Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Low Interest Rates exposure.

The central bank was very clear about its plans, which was the problem.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 243 / 357

Opioid Epidemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality

▲ Litigation

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure, 4 per Litigation exposure, and 4 per Health Price exposure.

Overdose deaths rose for two decades, and the lawsuits followed.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 236 / 357

Volcker Shock

RATES - AS-IF REPLAY, 1979



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Rates

▲ Liquidity

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Rates exposure, 2 per Liquidity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

In October 1979 the Federal Reserve let short-term rates climb toward 20% to break inflation, and the savings and loans that had funded 30-year mortgages with passbook savings never recovered.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 295 / 357

Asbestos Claims

LITIGATION



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

DEVELOPING EVENT

▲ Litigation

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped; Developing Event: stage 1 now, the next stage at the end of each later round.

Stage 1. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Stage 2. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Stage 3. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

The exposure was decades old, and the claims kept coming for decades more.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 285 / 357